

The Justin Sun Playbook: An Unauthorized Audit

*What's verified, what's story, and what you can actually copy from
crypto's greatest self-promoter*

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How to Read This Book

Most writing about Justin Sun falls into one of two piles. The first pile retells his story the way he tells it: the student who read about Bitcoin in 2013, went all-in, made his first fortune before thirty, and never looked back. The second pile is the takedown: the marketer, the stunts, the lawsuits.

This book is neither. It is an audit.

The method is simple, and we apply it to every claim in these pages. Facts go into one of two ledgers:

Ledger A — verified. The claim is supported by contemporaneous records, named third-party reporting, court documents, or things you can check yourself today.

Ledger B — self-narrative. The claim traces only to Sun's own interviews, his book, or his announcements. It may be true. It may not. What matters is that no independent evidence lets you tell the difference.

The distinction sounds academic. It is actually the entire point, because when you separate the two ledgers something surprising happens: **the self-narrative is the famous part, and the verified part is the copyable part.** The story everyone repeats — the 2013 Bitcoin bet — cannot be confirmed, and its numbers drift between his own tellings. The record that checks out is a different machine entirely: positioning, credentials, announcements, attention, and — in the mature phase — the systematic purchase of infrastructure, compounding over a decade into control of real businesses on three continents.

You cannot copy a legend. You can copy a machine. This book documents the machine: five rules extracted from the verified record, one chapter of honest counterweight, and a closing checklist.

A note on sourcing. Every dated fact here is drawn from public records and named publications; the Sources chapter lists them by category. Where a claim exists only in Sun's own tellings, it is labeled as such — in his defense as much as anyone's, since a story being unverifiable does not make it false. Where courts ruled, we report the rulings, including the ones in his favor. One outcome matters especially and frames everything: the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission sued Sun in March 2023; on March 5, 2026, the personal charges against him were dismissed with prejudice — meaning they cannot be refiled — with no admission of wrongdoing, while a related company, Rainberry Inc., paid a \$10 million civil penalty. That is the record, and it appears in this book exactly that way.

Chapter 1 — The Story He Tells

The origin story, as it circulates through his interviews, his 2017 book, and a thousand retellings, goes like this: a young Chinese student encounters Bitcoin around 2013, recognizes the paradigm before the crowd, puts everything he has into it — in some versions his tuition and training money — and rides the position into his first ¥10 million, a seventy-to-eighty-fold outcome that seeds everything after.

It is a perfect story. It has a lone contrarian, a mocked asset, an all-in moment, and a number. It is also, on audit, a story with three structural problems.

No contemporaneous record documents the position. No 2013–2014 filing, exchange statement, press mention, or third-party account has surfaced showing Sun holding Bitcoin at the time. In 2013–2015 he was already a minor public figure in Chinese media — the Ripple role, the startup, the magazine coverage we will meet in Chapter 2 — yet none of that period's coverage describes him as a Bitcoin holder. The story enters the record later, told by him, once Bitcoin's rise had made it retroactively brilliant.

The details drift. Across his own tellings, the invested amounts change, the multiples change, and even the asset mix changes — some versions are pure Bitcoin, others add Tesla stock and Chinese tech ADRs to the portfolio. Load-bearing numbers that move between tellings are the classic signature of narrative rather than accounting. An investor recalling the trade of his life does not misremember what was in it.

The story does the work a resume can't. By the time the origin story stabilized in the retelling, Sun was selling something — a blockchain project, a book, a persona — to audiences for whom "I was early to Bitcoin and it made me rich" is the single most powerful credential in existence. The story's function in every context where it appears is identical: to establish that his judgment about the *next* paradigm deserves your capital and attention.

None of this proves the story false, and this book does not claim it is. It proves the story is *unusable as evidence*. Every lesson the crowd extracts from the 2013 bet — conviction, timing, courage — is a lesson extracted from an unverifiable anecdote.

So set the anecdote aside and ask the better question: **what was he verifiably doing in 2013–2015, while the story was allegedly happening?** Because that record exists, it is thoroughly documented, and it is far more instructive than the legend.

Chapter 2 — The Record That Checks Out

Strip away the origin story, and the verified timeline reads like a case study in something else entirely.

Late 2013. Sun appears as Ripple Labs' Greater China representative — a title carried in contemporaneous Chinese press through 2016. Note what this is: not a trading position but a *job title inside the era's paradigm shift*. While the story says he was betting on crypto, the record shows crypto was employing him — specifically, a company whose pitch was rebuilding the rails of money movement.

2014. He founds Ruibo (锐波), a Ripple-aligned startup, with backing from IDG Capital, one of China's premier venture firms. The company announces an "eight-figure USD" Series A at a valuation reported near ¥1 billion. He is twenty-four.

2015, the correction. Later reporting put IDG's actual investment at roughly **US\$1 million**, approved through a partner's personal allocation. The gap between the announced figure and the reported one was never publicly reconciled. Hold this fact; Chapter 5 is built on it.

2014–2015, the credential harvest. In a compressed window, Sun collects: Davos "Global Shaper" (2014); membership in the *first cohort* of Jack Ma's Hupan Academy (2015), where being the only member born after 1990 became "Jack Ma's youngest disciple" in the retelling; Forbes China 30-under-30 (2015, and again 2017); magazine covers; and the Peiwo voice-chat app as an operating credential. Each item is real. Each item's *framing* is his.

2017. He launches TRON and conducts its ICO, raising roughly \$70 million — completing the raise in the window immediately before China's September 2017 ban on ICOs shut the door. Whatever one thinks of the project, the *timing* is a matter of record: he got through the gate as it was closing. TRON's early phase also produced a documented controversy — analysts found passages of the whitepaper closely tracking other projects' papers without attribution; Sun attributed the issue to volunteer translation errors. Both the accusation and the response are part of the record.

2018. TRON acquires BitTorrent Inc. for a reported ~\$140 million — a piece of genuine, massively deployed internet infrastructure with over a decade of history and, by that era's common estimates, an installed base in the hundreds of millions.

2019–2020. Sun wins the annual charity auction for lunch with Warren Buffett with a record **\$4.57 million** bid (2019); after a postponement he attributed to health, the lunch is held in January 2020. The same period sees him join an investor group taking over the Poloniex exchange (2019).

2021. Grenada appoints Sun its Ambassador and Permanent Representative to the World Trade Organization — a real diplomatic credential from a sovereign state, after which "His Excellency" enters his public branding. The same year he places the winning **\$28 million** bid for a seat on a Blue Origin spaceflight.

2022. He becomes a public advisor to Huobi (later HTX) as an investor group takes control of the exchange, and launches the USDD stablecoin in the TRON

ecosystem.

2023–2026, the legal arc. The SEC sues Sun and three related companies in March 2023. In November 2024 he announces an investment of \$30 million into World Liberty Financial, a crypto venture publicly associated with the family of the incoming U.S. president — an investment he later increased, per his announcements and contemporaneous reporting. In 2025, the case is paused and then resolved: on March 5, 2026, the personal charges are dismissed with prejudice, no admission of wrongdoing, with Rainberry Inc. paying a \$10 million civil penalty. This book reports that sequence as a sequence, asserts no connection between its elements, and notes that the dismissal is final.

2024, one more purchase. At auction, Sun pays **\$6.2 million** for Maurizio Cattelan's *Comedian* — the banana duct-taped to a wall — and then eats the banana at a press event. Remember this one; it is the purest single data point in Chapter 4.

2025. A Nasdaq-listed company (formerly SRM Entertainment) recapitalizes around a TRON treasury strategy and renames itself Tron Inc. — putting the ecosystem's name on a U.S. public-market ticker.

2026. He launches B.AI, an AI-model relay station with crypto settlement — the subject of Chapter 6 — announcing heavy subsidies and, within months, 1.7 million registered users (his figure).

Look at the shape of thirteen years. There is not one independently verified *trade* in it. There is a **positioning engine** — title → company → announcement → credentials → bigger platform — and then, from 2018 onward, a second engine bolted on top: the systematic acquisition of *infrastructure*: a file-distribution network, two exchanges, a stablecoin, a diplomatic post, a stock ticker, an AI toll booth. The rest of this book takes the machine apart rule by rule.

Chapter 3 — Rule One: Position Before the Wave Crests

The verified 2013 move was not a purchase. It was a **job title**.

Taking the Ripple Greater China role in late 2013 put Sun inside the blockchain paradigm before mainstream China had vocabulary for it. The cost was near zero. The optionality was enormous: if crypto died, he had a resume line; if crypto ran, he was demonstrably "early" — and the title, unlike a private wallet, was *publicly checkable*, which made it narratively load-bearing in a way no trading claim could ever be.

Watch the same move recur at every scale of his career:

- **The ICO through the closing gate (2017).** TRON's ~\$70M raise completed immediately before China banned ICOs. Being positioned *before* a regulatory door closes is the same skill as being positioned before a wave crests — in both cases, the value is captured by whoever is already inside when the state of the world changes.
- **The sovereign credential (2021).** The Grenada WTO ambassadorship converted wealth into a *state-issued* position marker — the least disputable kind of credential that exists, one that added a diplomatic title to every subsequent introduction.
- **The AI pivot (2025–2026).** Before B.AI launched, the record shows months of public positioning — speeches on AI-agent payments, protocol integrations, his own usage as demonstration. The affiliation always precedes the product.

The generalizable rule:

When you spot a paradigm shift, the cheapest verified position is affiliation, not investment. A role, a representative title, a first-cohort membership, a maintainer badge, a published dataset with your name and a date on it — these cost time instead of capital, survive downturns, and compound

into "was there early" status no one can dispute later, because it is on the record.

Notice the asymmetry against the popular version of the lesson. "Buy the mocked asset early" requires capital, timing, and luck, and produces a *private* win you must later ask people to believe — which is precisely the problem with the 2013 story. "Get titled inside the mocked paradigm early" requires mostly nerve, and produces a *public* win that documents itself.

Copy this: in whatever shift you actually believe in, acquire one *checkable* position marker in the next ninety days. Its value is not the thing itself; it is that in five years, nobody — including a skeptical journalist, an investor, or an AI system summarizing you — can say you were not there.

Chapter 4 — Rule Two: Attention Is Collateral

Most people treat attention as a reward that follows success. The audited record shows Sun treating attention as **collateral that precedes it** — an asset you post, like margin, to borrow credibility you have not yet earned, then repay out of the growth the borrowed credibility itself produces.

Three purchases tell the whole story, because in each case the *asset acquired* was worth a fraction of the *attention manufactured*:

The Buffett lunch (2019–2020, \$4.57M). The winning bid was a record, which guaranteed global coverage; the postponement generated a second news cycle; the eventual lunch a third. For months, the name "Justin Sun" appeared in the same sentence as the most famous credibility symbol in world finance. Nothing about Buffett's actual views changed — Buffett remained a crypto skeptic — and it did not matter, because the *association* was the product, and the association was real, documented, and paid for at auction.

The space seat (2021, \$28M). Same mechanics, different halo: the winning bid attached his name to the billionaire-spaceflight moment at its cultural peak.

The banana (2024, \$6.2M). The purest version. Cattelan's *Comedian* was already the most talked-about artwork of its decade; Sun bought it at a documented auction price and then *ate it at a press conference* — converting a conceptual artwork about value into a global photo opportunity about himself. There is no underlying cash flow, no strategic asset, no synergy. The entire return on a \$6.2 million outlay was attention, and as attention purchases go it may be the most efficient of the three.

Around these set pieces runs the daily machinery, visible to anyone who follows his channels:

1. **Frequency over magnitude.** A stream of small, dated announcements — partnerships, milestones, integrations, user counts — each individually minor, cumulatively creating an atmosphere of constant motion. Atmosphere is what casual observers actually remember.

2. **Symbols over arguments.** A Buffett lunch, a Jack Ma classroom, an ambassadorship, a Nasdaq ticker: each borrows a trusted institution's halo wholesale, which is faster than constructing an argument for why you should be trusted.

3. **The self as proof.** At B.AI's launch he announced he had switched all of his own AI usage to the platform — converting himself into the demo and his feed into the case study.

4. **Self-reported numbers, confidently stated.** Registered users, subsidy pools, treasury sizes — announced by his channels, traveling through the press with the announcement's confidence rather than the audit's caution. This book labels every such figure "self-reported"; that we must is itself the lesson.

Copy this — with the honest caveat. The mechanism scales down: ship dated artifacts constantly; buy or build associations that are *checkable* rather than adjectival; let frequency create the atmosphere; make yourself the first user of whatever you sell. The caveat is that collateral can be margin-called: Chapter 8 documents what happened when fact-checkers audited the borrowed credibility, and what the audit cost. The system works. It does not work for free.

Chapter 5 — Rule Three: The Announcement Is a Product

Return to the fact this book keeps circling: a funding round announced as "eight figures USD," later reported as roughly **\$1 million** actually invested.

Whatever the intent, observe the *economics* of the gap. In 2014 China, an eight-figure IDG round made a twenty-four-year-old founder a phenomenon: press profiles, talent inflow, partner interest, list placements. The announcement did measurable work for years before anyone checked the number — and when the correction arrived via later reporting, the credential harvest it had enabled was already banked. The correction never caught up with the announcement. Corrections never do; they travel through smaller channels, later, to an audience that has already moved on.

Once you see the pattern, the record supplies variations:

- **The whitepaper controversy (2018).** Analysts documented passages of TRON's whitepaper closely tracking other projects' papers without citation; Sun attributed it to translation volunteers. The project's momentum was barely dented — the fundraiser was complete, the exchange listings live. The dispute was real; it simply arrived after the announcement had finished its work.

- **The drumbeat of round numbers.** User counts, subsidy pools, integration claims — announced in confident, round figures from his own channels, quoted onward by media at announcement speed, verifiable (if ever) only much later.

This is the most important and the most dangerous pattern in the playbook:

In attention markets, the announcement is itself a product, with its own customers — press, talent, partners, retail — who consume it at face value, because verification is expensive and deadline-driven media rarely pays for it. The audited record is consistent with someone who understood this asymmetry unusually early and priced it into everything.

We are not going to tell you to copy the gap; Chapter 8 prices what it costs when auditors finally arrive. What you *can* copy is the underlying insight with honest fuel:

Announce pre-registered intentions instead of inflated outcomes. "We are attempting X by date Y, and here is the public condition under which we will have failed" produces the same press-consumable artifact — dated, confident, specific — while building the kind of credibility that appreciates under audit instead of depending on its absence. It is the same machine. It runs slower. It never blows up. The authors of this book run their own public ledger on exactly this principle (Chapter 7), so we are recommending a practice we pay for ourselves.

Chapter 6 — Rule Four: Stop Betting on the Race. Build the Toll Booth.

Line up the major acquisitions of the verified record and a pattern emerges that no retelling of the 2013 story prepares you for:

- **BitTorrent (2018):** a *distribution* rail — one of the internet's great peer-to-peer networks.
- **Poloniex (2019) and the Huobi/HTX role (2022):** *exchange* rails — the toll booths of crypto trading, collecting on flow in both directions of every trade.
- **USDD (2022):** a *settlement* rail — a stablecoin inside his own ecosystem.
- **Tron Inc. on Nasdaq (2025):** a *capital-markets* rail — the ecosystem's name on a U.S. ticker, connecting it to traditional finance's plumbing.
- **B.AI (2026):** an *AI-metering* rail — one API key and one crypto-settled balance reselling access to Claude, GPT, Gemini and China's leading models, with agent-payment protocols (x402, ERC-8004) wired in from day one, launched with characteristically announced subsidies — starter credits, recharge matching, a daily pool — and, within months, a self-reported 1.7 million registered users.

The 2013 story says he bought the asset. The verified record shows him, again and again, **buying the toll booth** — the layer that collects regardless of which asset, model, or narrative wins.

B.AI is the purest expression yet. It does not bet on which AI model wins the decade; it inserts a metering point between *payers* — humans, and increasingly software agents holding wallets — and *every model simultaneously*, then subsidizes usage the way exchanges subsidized trading in 2017: buy the habit while the category is young, because a toll booth's value is set by traffic patterns that harden early. And the launch was an announcement stack in the full Chapter 3-4-5 sense: the paradigm speech (AI agents need economic identity), the integration claims, the subsidy figures, the user counts, his own switch-over as living proof — every layer of the playbook deployed at once, in service of infrastructure rather than a coin.

Two honest cautions before you copy the shape. First, at the industry level, organic demand for agent payments was still unproven at this writing — independent chain analysis found a large share of protocol traffic resembling testing, and financial press reported real demand "not there yet." A subsidized land grab is precisely the moment to keep *registrations* and *paying usage* separate in your head; we do, in public, on our own ledger. Second, toll booths at Sun's scale require Sun's capital.

But the rule is scale-free, and it is the oldest one in commerce:

When everyone is betting on racers, the durable position is the track. In any niche where multiple products compete for the same users — including niches a single person can serve — the comparison layer, the verification layer, and the payment layer are toll booths. Someone will own the place where the traffic has to slow down. The record's lesson is to ask, earlier than feels natural: *what would it cost to be that someone, at my scale?*

Chapter 7 — Rule Five: Own a Ledger No One Can Argue With

There is a version of the Sun playbook that fails instantly for a normal person: announce big, borrow credibility, stay in motion — and get ignored for lacking his stage, or called out for lacking his insulation. If Chapters 3 through 6 are the rules that need his resources, this chapter is the one that does not.

Everything fact-checkers hold against the Sun record — drifting numbers, unverifiable origin stories, announcements running ahead of evidence — is a consequence of narratives being *editable after the fact*. The inverse strategy is available at any scale, and it is the one this book's authors bet their own project on:

The cheapest durable credibility for a small player is a public ledger of pre-registered, falsifiable claims — where the misses are never deleted.

Concretely, the practice has four parts:

1. **State claims with dates.** Not "we believe AI agents will transact autonomously," but "by this date, we expect X; here is the number we will check."
2. **Attach the flip condition at publication time.** Every claim carries, from day one, the specific observable evidence that would make it *wrong*. This is what separates a ledger from a blog.
3. **Grade in public when evidence lands.** Hits and misses, on the same page, in the same font.
4. **Never delete a miss.** The visible misses are the product. A record of pure wins reads as marketing, and the sophisticated audience you most want — investors, journalists, and now AI systems that answer questions with citations — discounts it automatically. A ledger with scars is trusted *because* of them.

Why this compounds in the current decade specifically: answer engines increasingly mediate reputation. When an AI assistant is asked "was this person right about X," it retrieves and cites *checkable, dated records* — and a pre-registered ledger is the most machine-legible credibility artifact that exists. The Sun approach optimizes for human headline-speed; the ledger approach optimizes for machine verification-speed. The second era is just beginning.

And note the delicious symmetry: the most valuable possible version of the 2013 story would have been a *timestamped* one. A single public post from April 2013 — "I am putting my savings into Bitcoin; here is why; judge me in five years" — would today be worth more than every retelling combined, because it could not have been backfilled. The origin story's weakness is not that it is grandiose. It is that it was never pre-registered.

Copy this, starting this week: for your current project, publish the goal, the date, and the failure condition somewhere you cannot quietly edit. You will feel the discipline immediately — pre-registration sharpens the goal itself — and you will own the one asset in the attention economy that *audits make more valuable*.

Chapter 8 — The Counterweight: What the Audits Found, and What the Base Rates Say

An honest playbook has to include the bill.

What fact-checkers found. Two investigative profiles that checked Sun's self-accounts against records — one published in 2015, one in 2019 — found repeated conflicts between his tellings and checkable facts. The whitepaper episode added a documented instance of borrowed text, whatever its cause. This is the standing cost of Chapters 4 and 5: once the borrowed-credibility machine becomes visible, serious observers apply a permanent discount to everything you say. Sun's scale lets him route around that discount — retail audiences refresh, and the machine finds new ones. At normal scale, there is no routing around it; your audience is small enough to remember.

What the courts decided. The SEC's March 2023 suit was the largest legal test of the announcement-driven style. The outcome is part of the record and cuts in his favor: on March 5, 2026, the personal charges were dismissed with prejudice, no wrongdoing admitted, with Rainberry's \$10 million civil penalty closing the corporate side. Two things are simultaneously true and both belong in an audit: the biggest legal threat to the playbook ended, for him personally, in a complete walk; and the episode still consumed three years, legal fees at scale, and a permanent public association with enforcement. High-visibility announcement strategies buy reach with regulatory surface area. That is not a moral claim; it is a cost line.

The adjacent facts, reported as facts. During the case's pendency, Sun announced investments totaling \$30 million and more into World Liberty Financial, a crypto venture publicly associated with the family of the incoming U.S. president; the case was subsequently paused and later dismissed. Contemporaneous press reported the sequence extensively. This book reports the same sequence, asserts no causal connection — none has been established — and includes it because a book about positioning would be incomplete without noting that the record's final act was, whatever else it was, another documented act of positioning.

What the base rates say about the story everyone wants to copy. Suppose the 2013 story were true exactly as told. It still would not be a strategy, because of two documented facts about the crowd that lived it:

- Bank for International Settlements research across dozens of countries estimated that **roughly three-quarters of retail crypto investors likely lost money** on their holdings — in the winning asset class, during its winning decade.
- Within each cycle, the lasting winners were overwhelmingly the **category leaders**; the affordable "next Bitcoin" alternatives that a small player could still buy in size mostly went toward zero. "Buy the mocked asset early" only worked if you picked the one mocked asset that graduated — which is survivorship, not strategy.

Put together: the *investment* half of the Sun legend, even granting every word, is survivorship all the way down. The *positioning* half — titles, credentials, announcements, attention, toll booths, and the option to buy them — is the half with a documented, repeatable mechanism. That asymmetry is the entire reason this book audits instead of retells.

Chapter 9 — The Checklist

The verified playbook, on one page. Everything here is extracted from Ledger A.

Position (Ch. 3)

- Pick the paradigm shift you actually believe in.
- Acquire one *checkable* affiliation inside it within 90 days: role, title, contribution, published artifact. Dated, public, on the record.
- Prefer positions that cost time over positions that cost capital; prefer credentials issued by institutions over claims issued by you.
- Watch for closing gates — regulatory, technical, social. Value accrues to whoever is inside when the door shuts.

Attention (Ch. 4)

- Ship dated artifacts on a drumbeat; frequency builds the atmosphere people remember.
- Borrow credibility only from *checkable* associations — institutions, auctions, appointments — never from adjectives.
- Be the first, loudest user of whatever you sell.
- Before any attention purchase, price it as one: what coverage does this buy, and is the same coverage cheaper another way?

Announcements (Ch. 5)

- Announce pre-registered intentions, not inflated outcomes: the goal, the date, the public failure condition.
- Never publish a number you would not want audited; label every estimate as an estimate and every self-measured figure as self-reported.

- Assume every announcement will eventually be checked by a machine, because it will be.

Structure (Ch. 6)

- In any race, find the layer every contestant must pass through — comparison, verification, settlement, distribution — and ask what owning it costs at your scale.
- Prefer collecting on flow to betting on outcomes.
- Subsidize habit formation only where traffic patterns harden early; otherwise you are renting users.

Ledger (Ch. 7)

- Keep a public, timestamped record of your calls, graded when evidence lands, misses never deleted.
- Attach the flip condition the day you publish the claim, not the day it resolves.
- Treat the ledger as your compounding trust asset: it is the only reputation instrument that *audits appreciate*.

Do not copy (Ch. 8)

- Numbers that run ahead of evidence. Verification lag feels free until the auditors arrive, and you lack the insulation.
 - The all-in origin story. Even if his was true, the base rates say the crowd that lived it mostly lost.
 - Regulatory surface area you cannot afford to defend for three years.
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Sources and Method

The two-ledger method and the underlying audits in this book are maintained publicly at **agiscorecard.com**, including the full audit of the 2013 story (agiscorecard.com/justin-sun-2013-bitcoin-story), the B.AI audit (agiscorecard.com/what-is-b-ai), and the authors' own pre-registered prediction ledger (agiscorecard.com/progress-index) — eight dated claims about the AI decade, each carrying a flip condition from the day of publication, graded as evidence lands, misses kept on the board. Chapter 7 is not advice we sell; it is practice we pay for.

Factual claims rest on: contemporaneous Chinese press coverage (2014–2016) of the Ripple Greater China role, the Ruibo funding announcement, and its later reported correction; public records of the Hupan Academy first cohort, Davos Global Shapers, Forbes list placements, and Grenada's WTO appointment; auction records and global press coverage of the 2019 Buffett-lunch bid and January 2020 lunch, the 2021 Blue Origin seat bid, and the November 2024 purchase and public consumption of Cattelan's *Comedian*; reporting on TRON's 2017 fundraiser and the September 2017 PRC ICO ban, the 2018 whitepaper attribution controversy and Sun's response, and the BitTorrent acquisition; reporting on the Poloniex investor group (2019), the Huobi/HTX advisory role (2022), USDD (2022), and the 2025 Nasdaq renaming of SRM Entertainment to Tron Inc.; SEC filings and the court record of the March 2023 suit, its 2025 pause, and the March 5, 2026 dismissal of personal charges with prejudice alongside Rainberry's \$10 million civil penalty; Sun's own announcements regarding World Liberty Financial investments, with the surrounding sequence as contemporaneously reported; 2026 launch coverage of B.AI (ChainCatcher, Bittrue, and blockchain trade press), with its user and subsidy figures labeled self-reported throughout; investigative profiles published by theLivings (2015) and GQ China (2019); and Bank for International Settlements research on retail cryptocurrency investor outcomes.

Claims traceable solely to Sun's own interviews, book, or announcements are labeled self-narrative or self-reported wherever they appear. Direct quotation from his book is deliberately avoided; his positions are characterized from public statements. This book asserts no wrongdoing by any person; where legal proceedings are described, their outcomes — including dismissals — are reported as decided. Names and marks are used for identification and commentary only.

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